The Happy Makers Present
DETECTIVE ACADEMY
THE MYSTERY OF ROOM ZERO
BOOK 1

EVIDENCE GRID / ROOM ZERO FILE
WHO LEFT THIS?
WHAT HAPPENED IN ROOM ZERO?
OBSERVE
ANALYZE
CONNECT
SOLVE
SCAN
ANALYZE
SOLVE
ROOM ZERO

HAPPY MAKERS DETECTIVE ACADEMY
THE MYSTERY OF ROOM ZERO
PUBLISHING INFORMATION

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THE BLACK ENVELOPE

Before anyone explains how the Academy works, the intake printer gives one mechanical cough.
Then it prints nothing.
Instead, a black envelope slides from the tray.
No stamp.
No sender.
One strange mark: 0.
Inside is a blank Detective Academy Recruit Credential.
No name.
No call sign.
No detective assigned.
A mistake?
A coincidence?
OR AN INVITATION MEANT FOR YOU?
WILL YOU CLAIM IT?

ORIENTATION
BEFORE YOU DECIDE

The Detective Academy is where small real-world mysteries become case files. New calls, reopened records, and strange pieces of evidence arrive through the Academy intake desk. Take a look inside. This is how it all begins.

WHAT TO EXPECT
01 CLUE INSPECTION
02 READING WITNESS STATEMENTS
03 COMPARING EVIDENCE
04 STUDYING MAPS & COORDINATES
05 DECODING MESSAGES
06 FOLLOWING PATTERNS
LOOK CLOSER. CHECK THE FACTS. LET THE EVIDENCE LEAD.

WHAT YOU ARE ABOUT TO WALK INTO

The Academy is not one room, and this investigation will not happen in one afternoon.

30 CONNECTED CASE FILES
Witness-board mysteries, map and coordinate puzzles, visual evidence, secret codes, timelines, sequencing challenges and logic deductions.

A TEAM THAT THINKS TOGETHER
The Happy Makers will be your team.
They compare clues, trade theories, drop case notes, make jokes at extremely professional moments and point out things worth checking.

YOU MAKE THE CALL
They do not get to make your verdict for you.
The cases get harder as your investigation grows.

STRANGER THINGS HAPPEN
A trophy returns before anyone logs it. A box marked EVIDENCE lands where it should not. Later, solved maps and forgotten records begin to matter again.

WHAT IS ROOM ZERO?
And somewhere inside the Academy, one question keeps returning:
LET'S MEET THE HAPPY MAKERS

MEET THE HAPPY MAKERS
THE ACADEMY FIELD TEAM

WHO THEY ARE
Five field detectives. One archive mentor.
Mimi, her children Luli, Dilo, Alio and Nini, and Grandma Bibi.
A family with six different ways of looking at the same mess.
They compare clues, challenge each other's theories and keep asking questions until the story starts to make sense.

HOW THEY WORK
Clues first.
Theories second.
Arguments occasionally.
Then they test what actually fits and quietly retire the theory that sounded brilliant five minutes ago.

WHY A TEAM?
Because no one notices everything.
Luckily, they rarely miss the same thing.
Bad news for mysteries.

THE SQUAD
MEET THE HAPPY MAKERS // FIELD TEAM 01

MIMI
FIELD DETECTIVE // CASE CAPTAIN
Runs the case table.
Can spot a theory forming on her children's faces.
Finds the tiny clue.
May need their help finding her own phone.
STRENGTH: Turns a muddle into the next useful step.
FUNNY HABIT: Organizes everything except what she just put down.
SMALL CLUES. BIG IDEAS.

LULI
FIELD DETECTIVE // CLUE ANALYST
The older sister who reads the small print.
Questions the big claim.
Spots contradictions.
Short replies. Long books.
May know what Dilo is about to say before he does.
STRENGTH: Spots contradictions and tests what evidence proves.
FUNNY HABIT: Can forget a book is not a substitute for lunch.
SMALL QUESTIONS. BIG DISCOVERIES.

DILO
FIELD DETECTIVE // CODE & TECH
Loves codes, games and close scores.
Connects numbers, machines and clever experiments.
Will help you test them.
STRENGTH: Finds patterns and connects the dots.
FUNNY HABIT: His confidence can finish before the test does.
TEST THE IDEA. TRY THE EXPERIMENT.

MIMI: I've got a plan! ...actually, wait, where's my phone?

LULI: Facts first. Opinions later. Snacks somewhere in between.

DILO: If it's weird enough to beep... it's probably important.

THE SQUAD
MEET THE HAPPY MAKERS // FIELD TEAM 01

NINI
FIELD DETECTIVE // PEOPLE & COURAGE
The youngest in the family.
Gives nervous people room to speak.
Notices feelings and details everyone skipped.
Asks small questions that can change a whole case.
STRENGTH: Looks beyond the obvious.
FUNNY HABIT: Gives names to things nobody else thought needed one.

ALIO
FIELD DETECTIVE // ROUTES & RECON
Asks the extra question.
Checks the unexpected corner.
Packed a helmet for this introduction.
STRENGTH: Notices routes and useful physical details.
FUNNY HABIT: Prepares for imaginary dangers before reading ordinary signs.

GRANDMA BIBI
ARCHIVE MENTOR // OLD ACADEMY GUIDE
Knows old shelves and stranger stories.
Connects historical records and knows what to verify.
Says when a memory is incomplete.
Stops nonsense without putting down her team.
STRENGTH: Finds context and the missing pieces.
FUNNY HABIT: Will defend an excellent old hat against the whole family.

NEXT: CLAIM YOUR RECRUIT CREDENTIAL
The Academy can invite you. Only you can choose to step in.

CLAIM YOUR RECRUIT CREDENTIAL

If you are in, this is the moment. No one else can fill this out for you. Beside the Case Table stands a small certification rack. Five badges hang on it. Hook 06 is empty. Mimi slides a pencil over. "Start with the name you want us to use."

DETECTIVE ACADEMY // RECRUIT CREDENTIAL
DETECTIVE NAME:
OFFICIAL CALL SIGN:
MY BEST DETECTIVE SKILL:
SIGNATURE:
FIRST CASE DATE:
ACADEMY STATUS: RECRUIT

Your best detective skill can be anything useful: noticing tiny details, remembering odd facts, asking good questions, staying calm, drawing maps, spotting patterns - or something only you know how to do. The credential gets you into the investigation. The cases decide what kind of detective you become.

HOW EVERY CASE WORKS

YOU NEVER NEED TO GUESS WHAT TO DO NEXT. EVERY CASE FOLLOWS THE SAME SIMPLE RHYTHM.

1 CASE FILE - WHAT HAPPENED?
Read the story first. It tells you where the case came from, what happened, and why this deduction matters.
2 YOUR OBJECTIVE
One exact thing to prove, find, sort, decode or reconstruct.
3 EVIDENCE
Witness boards, maps, photographs, records, codes, timelines, scraps and strange Academy files.
4 HAPPY MAKERS CHAT
The squad thinks out loud, jokes, questions theories and helps you notice what deserves attention.
5 MAKE THE CALL
Use the response made for that case: circle it, mark it, sort it, enter the code or write the coordinate. Then move on.
6 SAVE IT?
Only some cases send something to the Case Wall. When the book says “CASE WALL → PAGE 13”, copy that item there. Otherwise keep the verdict on the case page.

MAP CASES
READ THIS ONCE

Some cases use an Academy floor grid to reconstruct where people were standing.
Read these rules once. Later map cases will only give you the case-specific key.

1 HOW TO READ A COORDINATE

Letters run across the columns.
Numbers run down the rows.
D3 = column D, row 3.
Use one coordinate system: the labels printed beside the grid you are solving.

2 STANDARD MAP CASE RULES

1. Place every witness exactly once.
2. Each witness finishes in a different row and a different column.
3. Use only printed witness statements and visible map features.
4. If a case asks for a room or area companion, that person is a lead for the next interview, not automatically guilty.
5. Keep every final witness position on the completed map. Do not erase it after writing the verdict.

3 MAP LEGEND

PERSON MAY STAND ON: open numbered/coordinate squares shown as usable floor space.
SQUARE BLOCKED BY: walls, fixed furniture, equipment or other clearly illustrated obstacles.
ROOM / ZONE: named areas on the map. If a rule specifically says ROOM, a ZONE does not count.
There is no secret gray category. If something is blocked, the map shows why.

NEXT UP: YOUR CASE WALL + HINT VAULT
THE NEXT PAGE IS YOUR CASE WALL. HERE'S HOW IT WORKS:

1 FIND THE PAGE
CASE WALL → PAGE 13
Go to the next page to see your Case Wall.
2 COPY THE ITEM
When the book tells you to, copy the correct item to the matching spot on the wall.
3 SOLVE WITH CLUES
Use the items on your Case Wall to spot connections and answer the big questions later.

DILO: I can fit all my theories on that wall.

LULI: Try the evidence first.

ALIO: What about a small shelf for promising theories?

NINI: Mine needs a cushion.

BIBI: Give it a question mark. We need to know which parts are still guesses.

MIMI: A detective without key notes in one place is like solving a case with 37 tabs open and 2% battery. Bold, chaotic, doomed.

HINT VAULT + SOLUTION FILES
Stuck? Use the Hint Vault at the back of the book.
HINT LEVEL 1: A small nudge.
HINT LEVEL 2: Narrow the search.
HINT LEVEL 3: A bigger push.
SOLUTION FILES: Full answers at the back.

CASE WALL // RECORD ZONES
Copy here only the items the book explicitly tells you to keep. Write clearly. Keep it tidy.
MATCHING MARKS
MESSAGES / RULES
CODES / COORDINATES
OPEN QUESTIONS
Not every case sends something here. Save only what the book tells you to save.

30 ACTIVE FILES
REAL MYSTERIES. BRIGHT MINDS. YOUR TURN.

No answers here. Just doors. Turn the page. Case 01 is waiting.

SOMETHING IS OFF
THE FILES ARE REAL.
THE TEAM IS READY.
BUT SOMETHING DOESN'T FIT.
IT'S TIME TO LOOK CLOSER.

THE ENVELOPE THAT WAS NEVER DELIVERED
CASE 01 // TRAINING // MISSION ACTIVE

Your Recruit Credential is barely signed when Mimi slides the black-envelope file back across the Case Table.
The printer log gives you one solid fact: the envelope was released from internal Academy stock.
No courier. No outside delivery.
Four visiting helpers were in the intake area at that exact minute.
The strange 0 can wait.
First, you need the cleanest thing the record can still prove:
WHO WAS STANDING AT DELIVERY WHEN THE ENVELOPE EMERGED?

TRAINING NOTE: This first grid teaches the Academy map method. Later map cases use the same logic with fewer obvious starting points.

MIMI: Internal stock. Good. We start with what we can prove.

ALIO: My leading theory has a secret tunnel and a minivan. No evidence yet. I will put a question mark beside it.

LULI: A good place for the question mark, Alio.

NINI: A small one. We need room for the facts.

DILO: If a tunnel turns up later, you can have the whole margin.

CASE 01 // THE INTAKE GRID

YOUR OBJECTIVE
IDENTIFY who was at Delivery when the black envelope emerged and record their square.
INVESTIGATION RULES
Place each helper once on the 4x4 intake map.
Each helper uses a different row and a different column.
Combine row clues, column clues and relative clues before using elimination.
HELPER ROSTER // QUILL / PIP / MORSE / KNOX

WITNESS BOARD
WITNESS STATEMENTS
01 QUILL was in row 1.
02 PIP was in row 3.
03 MORSE was in column C.
04 KNOX was in column D.
05 PIP was somewhere to the left of QUILL.
06 MORSE was in a lower row than KNOX.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 18.

CASE 02 // FILE A

THE TROPHY THAT CAME BACK TOO EARLY

That morning, Mimi crosses Trophy Hall with coffee in one hand and the other buried in her bag, looking for the phone she was holding five minutes ago. She notices the Founders' Cup is missing from its display case. That part is normal. Max signed it out for a Hall demonstration. A few hours later, Dilo passes the same case and mentions that the Cup is back - polished, centered and apparently having a much more organized day than the rest of them. Mimi stops. "Back?" Bibi checks the return sheet. Blank. Clipped to the return record is an Academy return tag stamped with one plain 0 - the same mark printed on the black envelope that brought you here. Nobody calls it a pattern yet. The Hall record still has one solid checkpoint from the demonstration window: Max's position, plus one other person in the same room. That person is not a suspect. They are the one pair of eyes that can answer the question the paperwork cannot: No return time. No signature. No handoff. Was the Cup already back during that checkpoint - or did it return later, after the record went dark?

ALIO:

The Cup has returned itself with suspiciously good posture.

LULI:

The Cup is not suspicious.

ALIO:

Its paperwork is.

MIMI:

Better. Investigate the missing handoff, not the trophy's personality.

NINI:

I liked the posture theory. But I am writing down the useful question.

CASE 02 // FILE B

THE TROPHY THAT CAME BACK TOO EARLY

FIND Max's only room companion and record their coordinate.

• Use the Standard Map Case Rules on page 11. • PERSON MAY STAND ON: bleacher, desk, stool.
• SQUARE BLOCKED BY: globe, lab bench, piano, teacher's desk.

CASE 02 // WITNESS RECORD

01 Nova was in row 3 and column B.

02 Dax was in the Display Room and in column D.

03 Rook was in a corner and beside a teacher's desk.

04 Atlas was in the Equipment Room and in column F.

05 Ivy was standing on a desk chair.

06 Max was the trophy keeper. Exactly one other person shared his room.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 21.

CASE 03 // FILE A

LULI'S LOOK-TWICE FILE

Dax gives Trophy Hall one useful fact: When Dax noticed the display case, the Cup was already back inside it. That narrows the unexplained return window. It still does not explain why the return sheet is blank. Trophy Hall pulls the two image files attached to the same checkpoint reference. Both are labeled REFERENCE COPY. Both claim to show the same room check. They do not. This is no longer a question of spotting one odd detail. If one image was attached to the wrong record, the team needs a complete mismatch list before it can trust either file. Luli puts the photographs side by side. "Ten differences," she says. "A complete list. Then we check which record each photograph belongs to."

CASE 03 // COMMS

LULI'S LOOK-TWICE FILE

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

NINI:

I have found a sparkle. I am calling it Inspector Glitter.

LULI:

Does Inspector Glitter show a difference between the photographs?

NINI:

Not yet. I may have promoted it too soon.

DILO:

A difficult first day.

LULI:

Inspector Glitter can sit with you. We still need all ten differences.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 24.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 25.

CASE 03 // COMPARE / RECORD

LULI'S LOOK-TWICE FILE

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 026

WHAT CHANGED? // YOUR TEN OBSERVATIONS

Use the photographs on pages 24 and 25. Record each changed object and describe what is different.

01 02

03 04

05 06

07 08

09 10

CASE 04 // FILE A

THE EVIDENCE BOX IN THE WRONG TENT

Your ten-change list confirms that these are not two copies of one room check. The file captions point to different records; the evidence case label inside the photographs confirms the mismatch. Photo A shows 017 - the current Trophy Hall file reference. Photo B shows 071. They cannot be photographs of the same room check. Trophy Hall goes back to the original paper packet. Photo B belongs to an older reference file. Max's signed return form is still in the current Trophy Hall record, filed behind the wrong image. The Founders' Cup was returned normally. The Cup mystery is closed. The 071 photograph is not. Luli saves that number. Before she can chase it, Academy Open Night floods the courtyard with demonstration tents and visiting families. Then a sealed black evidence box from the Trace Lab turns up in the Pickup Tent beside ordinary event supplies. The seal is intact. The contents are safe. Its intake label carries the same plain 0. Three sightings are enough to make everyone uncomfortable. Not enough to explain anything. The problem in front of you is still the handoff. Pixel is the last confirmed person in the transfer record. Rebuild the tent snapshot and find the witness who can say whether Pixel arrived with the box, found it there or saw it change hands.

DILO:

It is a very suspicious black box.

MIMI:

It is a labeled evidence box.

DILO:

Exactly. Suspicion with paperwork.

NINI:

Please do not interrogate the box before the people.

ALIO:

May I stare at it professionally?

MIMI:

You have been doing that for a full minute.

CASE 04 // FILE B

THE EVIDENCE BOX IN THE WRONG TENT

FIND the one person who shared Pixel's Pickup Tent and record their coordinate.

• Use the Standard Map Case Rules on page 11. • PERSON MAY STAND ON: bench, bumper car, gondola. • SQUARE BLOCKED BY: cotton candy machine, popcorn cart, prize shelf, ring toss stand, strongman game.

CASE 04 // WITNESS RECORD

01 Echo was in row 2 and column A.

02 Kai was the only person in the Kitchen.

03 Zuri was in the Pickup Tent and in row 4.

04 Briar was beside a ring-toss stand.

05 Clover was in the Packing Room and in row 5.

06 Pixel had the collection list. Exactly one other person shared her room.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 29.

CASE 05 // FILE A

DILO'S CODE THAT DEFINITELY WASN'T 123456

Zuri's account gives Mimi enough to repair the evidence-box handoff and route the sealed box back to the Trace Lab. The moment she files the correction, Dilo's console flashes. A dormant locker beneath the Case Table has linked itself to the current Academy session. That has never happened before. Behind its six-symbol panel sits an old sealed Academy envelope. Nobody knows why the locker woke up. Nobody knows why it waited for a verified case to be filed. Dilo looks at the keypad. "One mystery at a time."

CASE 05 // COMMS

DILO'S CODE THAT DEFINITELY WASN'T 123456

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

DILO:

I challenge you to beat my locker.

LULI:

Does it know this is a competition?

DILO:

It has been briefed.

LULI:

Then we shall read its clues politely.

NINI:

If the locker wins, does it get a badge?

DILO:

Absolutely not. Conflict of interest.

CASE 05 // FILE B

DILO'S CODE THAT DEFINITELY WASN'T 123456

DECODE the one six-symbol order that makes every clue true.

• Use each of the six symbols exactly once. • Every CODE CLUE must be true at the same time.

• Record the final sequence in all six slots.

CASE 05 // WITNESS RECORD

01 STAR comes immediately before BOLT.

02 BALL appears somewhere before STAR.

03 HEART appears somewhere after BOLT.

04 KEY appears somewhere before MOON.

05 HEART appears somewhere before MOON.

06 HEART is not fifth.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 33.

ACADEMY FILE / FOUR MATCHING MARKS

ROOM ZERO THREAD // FOUR MATCHING MARKS

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY
034

ACADEMY RECORD / FOUR MATCHING MARKS

The locker accepts your six-symbol code. Inside the sealed envelope is one old Academy routing card. Almost everything on it is blank. Two things are not: STATUS: INCOMPLETE and a plain black 0. Nobody knows what the route was, what it was supposed to finish or why your filed cases woke it up. Mimi checks the intake tray. For once, nothing new slides out. On the Case Wall, four controlled records now carry the same plain 0: the black-envelope intake record, the Trophy Hall tag, the Open Night evidence label and the old locker routing card. The Look-Twice file came through the same intake system but carries no mark. Luli clips the two mismatched photo copies to the file instead of throwing either one away. "Solved is not the same as useless." Four matching marks prove a pattern. They do not explain it.

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

DILO:

Four marks. One incomplete route. One machine with dramatic timing.

LULI:

Pattern first. Explanation later.

ACADEMY FILE / FOUR MATCHING MARKS

ROOM ZERO THREAD // FOUR MATCHING MARKS

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY
035

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS / THE ARCHIVE

NINI:

Good. We still have room for a better idea.

BIBI:

And now we have something worth taking to the archive.

CASE WALL / PAGE 13

MATCHING MARKS: draw one plain 0 and list the four records carrying it. CODES / COORDINATES: copy your six-symbol locker code exactly. OPEN QUESTIONS: write WHAT WAS THE INCOMPLETE ACADEMY ROUTE? Do not add the Look-Twice file as a fifth mark. It was routed, not marked.

CASE 06 // FILE A

THE DRAGON TOOTH THAT

WAS ACTUALLY A SPOON

The next morning, Luli goes back to the Look-Twice mismatch list. Difference #1 is still bothering her: 017 / 071. This time she checks the Academy records index. 017 is the current Trophy Hall reference. 071 is older. Its archive entry is linked to the retired intake collection kept in Heritage. It was not a typo. Photo B came from a different file. Bibi takes the 071 reference to the Academy Heritage Gallery and goes looking for the older intake trail. She gets three steps through the door before Uma, the registrar, intercepts her. "Good," Uma says. "You're here. I have a dragon problem." The display label reads CEREMONIAL DRAGON TOOTH. The object underneath is a perfectly ordinary Roman spoon. Uma can prove where she was during the relevant window. What she cannot prove is whether the object moved or the label did. The map gives her one person to ask first - the person who shared that room and may remember what was under the label before the mismatch was noticed.

CASE 06 // COMMS

THE DRAGON TOOTH THAT WAS ACTUALLY A SPOON

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

NINI:

I had emotionally prepared for a dragon tooth.

LULI:

I know. I was hoping for the tooth too. We have a Roman spoon.

NINI:

Less dramatic. Better for soup.

DILO:

So do we have a missing dragon tooth or an overpromoted spoon?

LULI:

Right now, we have a label and an object that disagree.

BIBI:

Which is why we ask before we name a crime.

NINI:

The spoon is taking this very well.

BIBI:

And one tiny number from the Look-Twice file got us here. Good catch.

CASE 06 // FILE B

THE DRAGON TOOTH THAT

WAS ACTUALLY A SPOON

FIND the witness sharing Uma's room and record their coordinate.

• Use the Standard Map Case Rules on page 11.

• PERSON MAY STAND ON: bench, stool. • SQUARE BLOCKED BY: display case, fern, pedestal, sarcophagus, skeleton, statue.

CASE 06 // WITNESS RECORD

01 Scout was in row 3 and column E.

02 Hugo was in the Dinosaur Gallery, beside a display case.

03 Arlo was in the Foyer and in row 2.

04 Vale was in the Gallery, beside a statue.

05 Wren was on a bench, beside the skeleton display.

06 Uma checked the labels. Exactly one other person was with her.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 39.

STORY BRIDGE

ACT 2 // THE PATTERN

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 040

By the end of the first stretch of cases, nobody asks whether you are coming with them anymore. Mimi just leaves space beside the next file. Real staff have asked for help, live cases have arrived and an old system keeps touching records it should not know about. Now the team has a pattern - and no explanation yet.

CASE 07 // FILE A

THE COSTUME THAT WALKED AWAY

Arlo's account gives the gallery the answer it needed. The Roman spoon belongs to the neighboring display. Nothing was stolen. The dragon-tooth label card moved. Bibi finally leaves Heritage with copies of the old intake forms she came for. On the way back, the team cuts through the Undercover Training Wing: mock hotel rooms, fake kitchens, disguise storage and several places Alio considers "excellent for recon." A trainer blocks the corridor. The giant moon costume has vanished from its rack. Gray signed the last inventory check. Rebuild the room snapshot and find who saw that rack during the last clean window - before the costume became everybody's problem.

MIMI:

Alio, how many cupboards have you checked?

ALIO:

Only the dramatic ones.

NINI:

The moon costume is larger than most cupboards.

ALIO:

Excellent. We have eliminated several cupboards.

MIMI:

A triumph of fieldwork.

CASE 07 // FILE B

THE COSTUME THAT WALKED AWAY

REBUILD the positions. Name Gray’s one companion and their square.

• Use the Standard Map Case Rules on page 11. • PERSON MAY STAND ON: bar stool, chair, massage table. • SQUARE BLOCKED BY: buffet, cart, palm, piano, range, washer.

CASE 07 // WITNESS RECORD

01 Blaze was the only person in the Rehearsal Room.

02 Indigo was either in the Dressing Room or the Rehearsal Room.

03 Willa was 2 grid steps from the stage range marker. Count row difference

plus column difference.

04 Zoe was against an outer wall and beside a costume cart.

05 Rocket was in row 5 and column E.

06 Gray's space contained exactly one other person.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 43.

CASE 08 // FILE A

ALIO'S ABSOLUTELY SAFE SHORTCUT

Zoe's account gives the trainer a real time window. The moon costume is still missing. The rehearsal clock is running. The prop room is on the far side of the Undercover Wing, and Alio has already drawn three "faster" routes to reach it. One runs into the closed Paint Corridor. One depends on the locked Staff Stairs. One might actually work. The team cannot check the prop room - or close the costume trail - until you find the route that survives the building.

CASE 08 // COMMS

ALIO'S ABSOLUTELY SAFE SHORTCUT

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

ALIO:

My route is beautifully straight.

MIMI:

Buildings sometimes interrupt a straight line.

ALIO:

I shall discuss that with the building.

MIMI:

After you read its door signs.

DILO:

I will hold the map. You handle negotiations with the door signs.

CASE 08 // FILE B

ALIO'S ABSOLUTELY SAFE SHORTCUT

CHOOSE the only permitted route to the prop room.

• The team must reach the prop room now; waiting is not an option. • A route fails if it uses the closed Paint Corridor or the locked Staff Stairs.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 47.

CASE 09 // FILE A

THE SYMBOL THAT SHOULDN'T BE HERE

The moon costume is exactly where the valid route leads: in the prop room, moved there for the evening drill. No theft. No walking costume. Alio's dramatic-cupboard investigation is officially closed. Back at the Academy, the old-system question is still waiting. Luli opens the Case Wall to MATCHING MARKS and lays out the four records you saved. Then she mixes in ordinary circles and dials that look just similar enough to be dangerous if you want the pattern too badly. "Same shape is not enough," she says. Bibi reaches the table and starts to say something. Then she catches herself and waits for your classification. Memory can wait while you test the marks.

CASE 09 // COMMS

THE SYMBOL THAT SHOULDN'T BE HERE

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

DILO:

You know something.

BIBI:

I remember something. That is not the same thing.

LULI:

We will check it with you.

ALIO:

I have prepared several incorrect memories in solidarity.

BIBI:

Keep them away from the evidence table.

ALIO:

Cruelly reasonable.

CASE 09 // FILE B

THE SYMBOL THAT SHOULDN'T BE HERE

MATCH the true Academy marks and exclude the lookalikes.

• Match both the symbol shape and the Academy-record context. • A circle or dial is not automatically the recurring Academy mark.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 51.

STORY CONTINUES

ROOM ZERO THREAD // BIBI REMEMBERS THE FORM

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY
052

Bibi studies your filed classification, taps the matching Academy form once and reaches for her coat.
"This is the form I remember," she says. "I do not remember what the zero meant."
Then she heads for the archive.
That is all the team gets - and, for once, nobody fills the gap with a tunnel.
Under OPEN QUESTIONS, add one note beneath the question you already saved: BIBI RECOGNIZES THE OLD FORM. ZERO'S MEANING STILL UNKNOWN.
Bibi takes the question - and the form - into the archive.

CASE WALL -> PAGE 13

CASE 10 // FILE A

THE ROBOT WITH TWO OWNERS

Bibi disappears into the archive with the true 0 samples and leaves the rest of the team with one instruction: "Records, not guesses." Ten minutes later, the Academy Science & Prototype Fair sends over a problem that looks almost designed to test her patience. A Tech Lab mentor rolls a silver training rover up to the Case Table. Behind it come two students. Both are carrying ownership sheets. Both sheets look legitimate. Both list the same rover. Dilo crouches beside the machine. "At least the robot seems calm." The access log is less calm. Dash is the last placement everyone agrees on. Rebuild his area and the team gets the human overlap the system log is missing - someone who can say which team actually had access when one rover somehow became two ownership records.

DILO:

Two teams. One rover. One truly upsetting cable tangle.

LULI:

Which problem are you solving first?

DILO:

Access record.

LULI:

Correct answer. Disturbing speed.

DILO:

Please log that separately.

CASE 10 // FILE B
THE ROBOT WITH TWO OWNERS

IDENTIFY the contact sharing Dash’s prototype area and their square.

• Use the Standard Map Case Rules on page 11.

• PERSON MAY STAND ON: bunk, seat. • SQUARE BLOCKED BY: console, crate, cryopod, locker, tank.

CASE 10 // WITNESS RECORD

01 Ember was on a demo seat and beside another demo seat.

02 Nico was in column F and on a demo seat.

03 Wyatt was in column B and beside a charging pod.

04 Finn was 7 grid steps from the coolant tank. Count row difference plus

column difference.

05 Beck was against an outer wall and beside a parts crate.

06 Vera's room contained a control console, but she was not beside any control

console in that room.

07 Dash's area contained exactly one other person.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 55.

CASE 11 // FILE A

MIMI'S EVIDENCE BAG PROBLEM

Ember's account fixes the rover problem. Only one team actually had the rover during the disputed access window. The second ownership sheet was a copied demo record that should never have been attached to the current file. Dilo removes the duplicate sheet. Mimi starts returning the evidence. Access cards. A cable tie. Two pens. An oat bar. And, after ten minutes of accusing the universe, her missing phone. The Science & Prototype Fair happened between 15:20 and 16:05. One timestamped record in the bag belongs to a completely different moment. Leave it in, and the timeline becomes false. Also, breakfast becomes Exhibit H. Mimi objects to both.

CASE 11 // COMMS

MIMI'S EVIDENCE BAG PROBLEM

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

NINI:

Your phone has been living beside the oat bar.

MIMI:

It was undercover.

NINI:

Does the oat bar know?

MIMI:

We protect our sources.

DILO:

I would like that entered in the bag report.

MIMI:

You would not.

CASE 11 // FILE B
MIMI'S EVIDENCE BAG PROBLEM

FIND the record that does not belong in the Science & Prototype Fair timeline and explain why.

• Only records A-D are timestamped case records for this question. • Circle the one timestamp that falls outside the printed 15:20-16:05 case window.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 59.

CASE 12 // FILE A

THE PARROT WHO KNEW THE PASSWORD

The wrong timestamp comes out of the science-fair file, and Mimi's breakfast is cleared of involvement. The next afternoon, the Academy Scenario Theater lends its stage to a visiting animal-care team. Halfway through rehearsal, Nini returns to the Case Table with a witness who has feathers, excellent lungs and extremely clear priorities. The parrot keeps repeating four words that sound exactly like the backstage access phrase. Nobody remembers teaching them. Winter is the one handler the rehearsal record places with certainty. Find the one other person in Winter's mapped area: that gives the team a grounded place to start asking where those four words came from.

CASE 12 // COMMS

THE PARROT WHO KNEW THE PASSWORD

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

DILO:

Please speak clearly for the notebook.

NINI:

Wait. I think it is asking us for something.

DILO:

The witness said cracker.

NINI:

A clear request. We are making progress.

DILO:

My neatest interview so far.

CASE 12 // FILE B

THE PARROT WHO KNEW THE PASSWORD

MATCH Winter to the one other person in the same mapped area. Give their coordinate.

• Use the Standard Map Case Rules on page 11. • PERSON MAY STAND ON: bench, dog bed, grooming tub. • SQUARE BLOCKED BY: bird cage, crate, platform, toy basket, tunnel.

CASE 12 // WITNESS RECORD

01 Kira was in the Bird Room, and nobody else entered it.

02 Nell was in the Stage Wing and in row 2.

03 Iris was the third person from the south.

04 Eli was either in the Green Room or the Bird Room.

05 Cove was in column B and against an outer wall.

06 Exactly one of Sage and Kira was in the Rehearsal Room.

07 Winter's area contained exactly one other person.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 63.

STORY BRIDGE

ACT 3 // THE BOOK REMEMBERS

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 064

A few days into the investigation, your chair at the Case Table has somehow become yours. Nobody discussed it. The next stack of files simply keeps landing beside you. And the solved cases stop feeling finished. Old photographs, saved maps and records that looked ordinary at first begin to matter again. The book has been keeping evidence for questions you did not know to ask yet.

CASE 13 // FILE A

THE CAMERA THAT BLINKED AT 4:17

Nell gives the animal-care team the least sinister answer available. During rehearsal, an ordinary stage cue used the same four words as the backstage access phrase. The parrot learned the cue. No password leak. Just excellent timing and a bird with no respect for context. That same afternoon, a ranger from the Academy Field Research Wing arrives holding a camera by its strap. "Please tell me cameras don't move themselves here." Dilo considers the question. Luli answers first. At 4:17, the camera captured a blurry frame. Later, it was found in a different position from the one marked on the maintenance sheet. Remy signed that sheet. Rebuild his room and you get something the camera cannot provide: a second human memory of the setup. That witness may be able to place the move before the photo, after it, or during the maintenance handoff. Alio quietly writes "fox with pockets" on a scrap of paper. Underneath, he adds a question mark. Nini pushes a pencil his way.

ALIO:

My fox theory has one weakness.

LULI:

Pockets?

ALIO:

Several weaknesses. I am making a list.

NINI:

I will keep a space for the answer.

ALIO:

Useful. Thank you.

LULI:

Start with what the camera saw.

CASE 13 // FILE B

THE CAMERA THAT BLINKED AT 4:17

FIND the contact sharing Remy’s room and their square.

• Use the Standard Map Case Rules on page 11. • PERSON MAY STAND ON: bench, exam table, jeep. • SQUARE BLOCKED BY: crates, dinosaur statue, feeding trough, giant fern, info kiosk, ranger desk.

CASE 13 // WITNESS RECORD

01 Juno was diagonally next to Skye; their corners touched.

02 Skye stayed in the Ranger Station.

03 Eden shared a room with Juno.

04 Willow was north-west of Bodhi: north and west by any number of squares.

05 Bodhi was south-west of Moxie: south and west by any number of squares.

06 Moxie was in the Ranger Station and in row 5.

07 Remy's room contained exactly one other person.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 67.

CASE 14 // FILE A

ONE WITNESS IS ACCIDENTALLY IMPOSSIBLE

Bodhi gives the ranger the missing piece. The camera was moved after the 4:17 frame during cleanup. It did not move itself, and nobody needs Alio's fox-with-pockets theory. What stays with Mimi is something more useful: two people remembered the same few minutes differently. Back at the Academy the following morning, the Scenario Theater coordinator overhears that conversation and drops four rehearsal statements onto the Case Table. "Then test these." One journey cannot physically fit the printed travel times. This time, the job is not to catch a liar. It is to prove which memory cannot work before confidence gets mistaken for truth - or confusion for guilt.

CASE 14 // COMMS

ONE WITNESS IS ACCIDENTALLY IMPOSSIBLE

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

DILO:

One statement has broken the clock.

NINI:

Or one person mixed up two moments.

LULI:

Test the journey before you test the person.

MIMI:

Exactly.

ALIO:

Can I remain suspicious of the clock?

LULI:

Certainly. Help me count its minutes.

CASE 14 // FILE B

ONE WITNESS IS ACCIDENTALLY IMPOSSIBLE

IDENTIFY the statement whose journey cannot fit its times.

• Each map edge takes 2 minutes to walk. • Count the route edges in every statement; no shortcut exists unless it is drawn.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 71.

CASE 15 // FILE A

THE BACKPACK THAT CHANGED OWNERS

The impossible rehearsal journey turns out to be a bad memory, not a bad person. Before sunrise the next day, the team is loading gear for an Academy field-skills trip. It is going well for almost forty seconds. Then two nearly identical backpacks end up with the wrong people. Someone moved one to "help." Someone else moved the other to "fix" that. A third person is now completely sure the blue zip means something important. The bus driver starts the engine. Milo is the cleanest fixed point in the departure record. His room companion saw one of the bags before helpfulness became a chain reaction. Mimi looks at the bus. "Fast case."

CASE 15 // COMMS

THE BACKPACK THAT CHANGED OWNERS

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

MIMI:

Next trip: readable name tags.

ALIO:

What about satellite tracking?

MIMI:

My tags work indoors.

ALIO:

Unexpectedly advanced technology. I will write mine large.

CASE 15 // FILE B

THE BACKPACK THAT CHANGED OWNERS

NAME the witness in Milo’s room and mark their location.

• Use the Standard Map Case Rules on page 11.

• PERSON MAY STAND ON: canoe, cot, stool. • SQUARE BLOCKED BY: backpacks, canoe rack, games shelf, welcome desk.

CASE 15 // WITNESS RECORD

01 Harper was north-east of Cruz: north and east by any number of squares.

02 Piper was north-east of Duke.

03 Duke was in the First Aid Hut and in row 5.

04 Cruz was beside a camp cot.

05 Jett was the only person in the Welcome Lodge.

06 Inez shared a room with a cot but was not beside it.

07 Milo's room contained exactly one other person.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 75.

CASE 16 // FILE A

GRANDMA BIBI'S VERY OLD, VERY

EMBARRASSING PHOTOGRAPH

Harper's account untangles the backpack swap before the bus pulls away. The blue zip identified a bag. It never proved who owned it. Two days later, Bibi returns from the archive carrying a flat box under one arm. She does not put it in the incoming tray. She puts it directly in front of you. Inside is a photograph of six children outside an Academy building nobody on the current team recognizes. One of the children is Bibi. Alio notices the hat first. "That is not a hat. That is architecture." Bibi gives him a look that suggests the architecture may be discussed later. She remembers the people in the photograph. She is less sure about the year. And on the back is handwriting she recognizes as her own - but memory is exactly what Case 14 taught you not to treat as proof. Before anyone reads the old note as evidence, the team has to establish where the photograph was taken and when.

CASE 16 // COMMS

GRANDMA BIBI'S VERY OLD, VERY EMBARRASSING PHOTOGRAPH

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

ALIO:

That hat could shelter the whole team.

BIBI:

It also had an excellent detective underneath it.

MIMI:

The hat is not admissible dating evidence.

BIBI:

Finally, a sensible Academy policy.

DILO:

Can we still admire it respectfully?

BIBI:

Within controlled limits.

CASE 16 // FILE B

GRANDMA BIBI'S VERY OLD, VERY EMBARRASSING PHOTOGRAPH

WORK OUT the photograph’s building and year.

- Prove the building and year from printed evidence, not Bibi's memory.
- Your answer must satisfy every dated clue at the same time.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 79.

STORY CONTINUES

ROOM ZERO CHECKPOINT // RULE 0 FIRST

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 080

Once you have made your building-and-year verdict, Bibi turns the photograph over.
Her younger handwriting is still there:
RULE 0 FIRST

STORY CONTINUES

NOBODY AT THE TABLE KNOWS THE MISSING RULE YET.

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY
081

Nobody at the table knows the missing rule yet. Under MESSAGES / RULES, copy that exact line from the back of the photograph. Nothing more. Do not complete the sentence from imagination.

CASE WALL -> PAGE 13

CASE 17 // FILE A

THE TRAIN TICKET THAT WASN'T LOST

The photograph is finally pinned down: the Old Academy Annex, years before the current Academy took shape. Only then does Bibi let the line on the back into the case:

RULE 0 FIRST

She remembers writing it. She does not remember what it meant. The Annex records are the next place to look, so the squad heads for Riverside Station. They do not make it past the ticket hall. A station staff member spots the Academy folders. "Detective Academy?" Mimi nods toward you. "That's us." A special open-day ticket has changed hands even though nobody reported losing it. Reed is the last reliable point in the station trail. Rebuild his area and find the person who can tell the team where the ticket went next - and whether anyone meant to pass it on at all.

CASE 17 // COMMS

THE TRAIN TICKET THAT WASN'T LOST

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

ALIO:

Railway-investigation helmet: deployed.

LULI:

It is the same helmet.

ALIO:

It has changed departments.

BIBI:

Then perhaps its first assignment can be reading the ticket sleeve.

DILO:

Does the helmet earn travel points?

BIBI:

Only if it buys its own ticket.

CASE 17 // FILE B

THE TRAIN TICKET THAT WASN'T LOST

TRACE the ticket record to the one person sharing Reed’s mapped area. Give their coordinate.

• Use the Standard Map Case Rules on page 11.

• PERSON MAY STAND ON: bench, seat. • SQUARE BLOCKED BY: luggage rack, stove, table, trunk.

CASE 17 // WITNESS RECORD

01 Otis was either in the Ticket Office or on the Baggage Platform.

02 Mika was in the Ticket Office and in column B.

03 Koa was in the Waiting Lounge and in row 6.

04 Sunny was on a bench.

05 Luna was in the Waiting Lounge and in column G.

06 Axel was exactly three rows north of Koa.

07 Reed's final area contained exactly one other person.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 85.

CASE 18 // FILE A

THE SEVEN-MINUTE ALIBI

Axel confirms the ticket did not vanish. Reed handed it on deliberately. The station file still seems to disagree with that account: one uncorrected timestamp places Reed elsewhere seven minutes before another record says the ticket changed hands. Dilo circles the gap. It looks important. It has not proved anything yet. Except the file was built from three clocks. The cafe clock is seven minutes slow. Dilo timed one checkpoint on a watch that is two minutes fast. The station camera shows real time. Four records. Three clocks. One apparent 0:07 gap. Before anybody promotes it into another Room Zero clue, every timestamp has to speak the same clock.

CASE 18 // COMMS

THE SEVEN-MINUTE ALIBI

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

MIMI:

Can your watch accept being wrong?

DILO:

It is handling the news with dignity.

NINI:

And its owner?

DILO:

Less gracefully. I am correcting the record.

LULI:

Good. Corrected time first.

CASE 18 // FILE B
THE SEVEN-MINUTE ALIBI

ORDER the four events by their corrected real times.

• Convert every shown time to REAL TIME before comparing events. • Cafe clock = real time - 7 minutes; Dilo's watch = real time + 2 minutes; station camera = real time.

• Write the four record letters in chronological order.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 89.

CASE 19 // FILE A

THE LIBRARY BOOK THAT CHECKED ITSELF OUT

The seven-minute "alibi" disappears the moment the clocks are corrected. The handoff fits. The ticket was never lost, and suspicious 0:07 is officially demoted to ordinary arithmetic. Dilo is the one who crosses it off. No argument. No appeal. Luli notices. She says nothing. The squad reaches the Old Academy Annex, copies the records Bibi needs and returns to the Academy. Luli takes the new material to the Media Library to compare it with the current archive database. The librarian meets her at the door. "The book checked itself out." The rare book is still sitting on its shelf. Sasha is fixed on the scanner log. Rebuild her area and the team gets the physical side of a digital mystery: someone who can say whether the scanner was used, bumped, tested - or simply produced a checkout nobody made.

CASE 19 // COMMS

THE LIBRARY BOOK THAT CHECKED ITSELF OUT

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

DILO:

I was going to say digital ghost.

LULI:

And now?

DILO:

I am postponing the ghost until evidence requests one.

LULI:

I like this plot development.

NINI:

If it turns up later, I am asking whether it likes books.

DILO:

After the scanner, then.

CASE 19 // FILE B

THE LIBRARY BOOK THAT

CHECKED ITSELF OUT

NAME the only person sharing Sasha’s area. Record their square.

• Use the Standard Map Case Rules on page 11. • PERSON MAY STAND ON: bleacher, desk, stool.
• SQUARE BLOCKED BY: globe, lab bench, lockers, piano, teacher's desk.

CASE 19 // WITNESS RECORD

01 Avery was exactly two rows north of Mack.

02 Theo was 7 grid steps from the piano.

03 Exactly one of Ollie and Avery was in the Archive Room.

04 Dex shared a room with Theo.

05 Mack was south-west of Ollie.

06 Kian was in the Study Hall and in column F.

07 Sasha's final area contained exactly one other person.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 93.

CASE 20 // FILE A

THE PAINT-SPLATTERED ALIBI

Mack remembers the exact moment. A return cart clipped the scanner stand while the rare book was still on its shelf. The scanner fired, the database logged a checkout and nobody actually carried the book anywhere. Digital ghost: denied. Leaving the library, the team passes the Flight Simulation Wing. The night crew is repainting modular cockpit panels, and one panel moved before the paint dried. The smear makes two later accounts look as if they cannot both be true. Demi's movement log is the last clean point before those accounts split. Put the room back together and one witness can separate before the wet panel moved from after it moved. Keep following the instruction from page 11: record every final position. Do not erase the map when the local question is solved.

CASE 20 // COMMS

THE PAINT-SPLATTERED ALIBI

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

NINI:

This panel looks like a very worried pear.

MIMI:

Give it a place on the art wall, not the witness list.

NINI:

Understood. Pear excluded from questioning.

DILO:

Does the pear have an alibi?

MIMI:

The pear is paint.

NINI:

Strong alibi.

CASE 20 // FILE B
THE PAINT-SPLATTERED ALIBI

RECORD the name and square of Demi’s one same-room contact.

• Use the Standard Map Case Rules on page 11. • PERSON MAY STAND ON: cadet bunk, pilot seat. • SQUARE BLOCKED BY: flight console, fusion reactor, oxygen tank, sleep pod, suit locker, supply crate.

CASE 20 // WITNESS RECORD

01 Sid was somewhere south of Pax.

02 Pax was south-east of Mara.

03 Luca was diagonally next to Asa.

04 Mara was in the Main Studio and in row 4.

05 Asa shared a room with Mara.

06 Toby was the only person in the Workshop Hall.

07 Demi's final room contained exactly one other person.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 97.

CASE 21 // FILE A

THE NOTE IN FOUR PIECES

Pax clears up the paint contradiction. The wet panel moved between the two accounts. Both witnesses were describing the truth - just on opposite sides of the move. Mimi files the complete placement map instead of stripping it down to the verdict. Late that evening, the Academy finally goes quiet. Then the intake printer gives one mechanical cough. The same cough it made on your first day. Every head at the Case Table turns. A strip of brittle paper slides from the tray. Not a case file. A handwritten note. Dilo reaches for it too quickly. The paper tears into four pieces. Nobody laughs. Mimi puts the evidence mat under the scraps. "Leave them there, Dilo. We can work with this." Luli moves the nearest folder out of his way. For the first time, the larger mystery may be trying to say something directly. And now its message is lying in four scraps across the evidence mat.

CASE 21 // COMMS

THE NOTE IN FOUR PIECES

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

NINI:

Nobody move the pieces.

DILO:

Both hands visible. I am learning.

LULI:

Tear edges first. Sentence second.

BIBI:

And keep the handwriting visible when you sleeve it.

NINI:

Familiar?

BIBI:

Maybe. Which is exactly why I am not calling it evidence yet.

DILO:

Understood. The paper gets the first interview.

CASE 21 // FILE B
THE NOTE IN FOUR PIECES

REBUILD the four-piece note and write its instruction.

• Use every scrap exactly once. • Match the tear edges first; use the sentence only to confirm a physical join.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 101.

STORY CONTINUES

ROOM ZERO THREAD // THE NOTE

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 102

Mimi slides your reconstructed note into a clear sleeve. Nini looks at the saved maps, then at the four scraps. "Empty what?" she asks. Luli leaves the question beside the note instead of filling it in. Dilo steadies the sleeve while Mimi closes it. Under MESSAGES / RULES, copy the full sentence you reconstructed in Case 21 exactly as you wrote it. The Case Wall is now holding an instruction nobody at the table knows how to use yet.

CASE WALL -> PAGE 13

STORY BRIDGE

ACT 4 // ROOM ZERO

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 103

For the first time, Room Zero has given you an instruction instead of another pattern. It has not bothered to explain how to use it. Nini slides the growing stack of solved maps into your reach. Nobody asks whether you are keeping them anymore. Of course you are. So the squad keeps working the real cases that arrive - and keeps every record that might matter later.

CASE 22 // FILE A

THE MUSIC ROOM MIX-UP

By morning, the repaired note is safe on the Case Wall. At Sound Lab, the shelves need their proper contents back. Three nearly identical instrument cases have been returned to the wrong shelves after rehearsal. Zara is the last reliable placement before the shelves changed. Her room companion saw the cases before the mix-up. Find that person so Sound Lab has one clean witness to the original shelf order - and keep the complete map. Mimi brings the file within your reach. "Let us put these back properly."

CASE 22 // COMMS

THE MUSIC ROOM MIX-UP

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

ALIO:

Three identical black instrument cases. Excellent. Objects have joined witness protection.

LULI:

They are labeled.

ALIO:

Weak cover identities.

NINI:

The instruments would like their own beds back.

DILO:

Then we had better sort out the bedrooms.

CASE 22 // FILE B
THE MUSIC ROOM MIX-UP

LINK Zara to the one witness in the same room. Record that witness’s square.

• Use the Standard Map Case Rules on page 11. • PERSON MAY STAND ON: bleacher, desk, stool.
• SQUARE BLOCKED BY: lab bench, lockers, piano, teacher's desk.

CASE 22 // WITNESS RECORD

01 Lex was diagonally next to Imani.

02 Imani and Nia shared a room.

03 Cody was diagonally next to Wes.

04 Exactly one of Nia and Lex was in the Practice Hall.

05 Gia was 7 grid steps from the piano.

06 Wes's room contained an instrument locker, but he was not beside any

instrument locker in that room.

07 Zara's final room contained exactly one other person.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 107.

CASE 23 // FILE A

THE WRISTBAND SWITCH AT ADVENTURE PARK

Cody confirms the instrument cases were still on the correct shelves before rehearsal teardown. The mix-up happened during the return rush, not during the performance. Sound Lab relabels the shelves, and another complete map joins the stack beside Nini. Nini keeps the repaired note beside the maps. That weekend, the Academy takes the team to a nearby Adventure Park for a field-observation challenge. For once, nobody is chasing an old archive system. Then two access wristbands switch owners. One opens the climbing zone. One opens the arcade. The return desk knows where both wristbands ended up. It cannot tell where the two routes crossed. Jude is the last place where a person and a location still line up in the log. Solve that area and his companion becomes the anchor point the desk needs before the wristband trails split in two directions. Dilo checks the arcade scoreboard. "Unrelated," Luli says. "I haven't said anything." "You were about to."

CASE 23 // COMMS

THE WRISTBAND SWITCH AT ADVENTURE PARK

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

DILO:

The arcade scoreboard has challenged me personally.

MIMI:

It displayed a number.

DILO:

In a tone.

LULI:

Solve the wristband case before you start a feud with a scoreboard.

DILO:

Feud postponed.

CASE 23 // FILE B

THE WRISTBAND SWITCH

AT ADVENTURE PARK

FIND the person sharing Jude’s area and record their square.

• Use the Standard Map Case Rules on page 11.

• PERSON MAY STAND ON: bench, gondola. • SQUARE BLOCKED BY: balloon cart, cotton candy machine, funhouse mirror, popcorn cart, prize shelf,

strongman game.

CASE 23 // WITNESS RECORD

01 Vivi was 7 grid steps from the gondola.

02 Cora was north-east of Mae.

03 Ozzy was south-west of Cora.

04 Rae was exactly two columns east of Cora.

05 Mae shared a room with a person who was on a bench. That person was

either Ozzy or Pia.

06 Exactly one of Pia and Vivi was in the Snack Stand.

07 Jude's final room contained exactly one other person.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 111.

CASE 24 // FILE A

THE FOOTPRINTS THAT WALKED BACKWARDS

The wristband trail finally has a clean handoff. On the walk back from the park, Alio stops so suddenly that Dilo nearly walks into him. "Backwards footprints." A line of muddy prints crosses the Academy's outdoor tracking yard. One tread groove forms a small arrow. Dilo crouches beside it. Alio starts pointing along the arrow, then lowers his hand. "Wait. Let me look at the whole trail." Mimi holds the tracking sheet where both of them can see it.

CASE 24 // COMMS

THE FOOTPRINTS THAT WALKED BACKWARDS

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

ALIO:

I have paused my dramatic theory.

LULI:

Voluntarily?

ALIO:

The muddy evidence requested a word.

LULI:

Give it the floor.

MIMI:

I will wait here while you check.

ALIO:

Good. I would like my next theory to have feet.

CASE 24 // FILE B

THE FOOTPRINTS THAT

WALKED BACKWARDS

TRACK the true direction of travel from the fading mud.

• This is one uninterrupted walk with no fresh mud added. • Wet mud transfers most strongly first and then fades. Ignore the decorative tread arrow.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 115.

CASE 25 // FILE A

THE PACKAGE WITH NO NAME

The muddy trail ends at the West Gate with no backwards walker and one useful reminder: the loudest-looking clue is not always the one that matters. At the Academy Guest House, reception has a different kind of trail. A parcel. No addressee. A return label that reads ARCHIVE RESTORATION. And a routing history made almost entirely of people saying, "I thought I was helping." Nori is the last name the record still trusts. Rebuild the Lobby snapshot and find his room companion - the next person reception can ask about the missing parcel handoff. Bibi reads the return label twice. This time, she does not say what she is thinking.

CASE 25 // COMMS

THE PACKAGE WITH NO NAME

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

NINI:

This parcel has met more helpful people than it can remember.

MIMI:

Then we help it in a less creative order.

DILO:

Revolutionary idea: one label, one destination.

ALIO:

And possibly biscuits.

MIMI:

We can investigate lunch after the handoff. I saved you a place.

CASE 25 // FILE B
THE PACKAGE WITH NO NAME

REBUILD the parcel snapshot. Name Nori’s room companion and their square.

• Use the Standard Map Case Rules on page 11. • PERSON MAY STAND ON: bar stool, bed, chair, massage table. • SQUARE BLOCKED BY: bar, buffet, cart, desk, palm, piano, range, washer.

CASE 25 // WITNESS RECORD

01 Gabe was diagonally next to Rio.

02 Casey was in the Lobby and in column D.

03 Rio was north-west of Gabe.

04 Tate was diagonally next to Wynn.

05 Sol was north-east of Gabe.

06 Wynn was in the Laundry and on a bar stool.

07 Nori's final room contained exactly one other person.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 119.

STORY CONTINUES

ROOM ZERO THREAD // THE OLD CASES COME BACK

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY
120

Mimi files the Guest House map. After Reception confirms the handoff with Casey, staff finally open the parcel. Inside are transparent overlay sleeves and old alignment clips borrowed long ago from Archive Restoration - exactly the kind Bibi needs for delicate plan work. Then the dormant routing light under the Case Table turns on. For the first time since the torn note, the intake printer moves by itself. A narrow strip slides out:

MAP SET: COMPLETE
SELECTED FILES: 14

Nini turns to page 13 and taps the message you saved from Case 21. Around her, the fourteen files named by the route are pulled from the case stack. Your Case 01 intake map stays clipped to the recruitment file: it started the route, but it is not one of the fourteen selected for this step. The old cases are about to become new evidence.

1 NINI
2 DILO

3 LULI
4 BIBI

MIMI:

HAPPY MAKERS CHAT

I knew we kept those maps for a reason. I kept mine because the stack looked impressive. Same evidence. Very different methodology. And the parcel finally delivered something useful instead of confusion. The Case Wall is finally earning its wall space.

CASE 26 // FILE A

THE CASE OF THE EMPTY ROOMS

The Guest House routing trail is repaired, the Archive Restoration tools stay with Bibi - and Nini stops halfway through filing the latest map. She looks at the instruction from Case 21. Then at the stack. Then back at the instruction. "We keep looking at what is on the maps." Luli follows her eyes. "The note says what we leave empty." That is why page 11 told you not to erase final placements. Fourteen spatial maps selected by the old routing system are now complete. Their people, rooms and empty spaces are still exactly where you proved them. Nini lays the maps in case-number order and locks the Case Room door. "Now we test it."

NINI:

Empty does not always mean useless.

DILO:

My bedroom would like that entered into evidence.

LULI:

Your bedroom is not an admissible precedent.

MIMI:

Fortunately.

BIBI:

Old systems sometimes hide meaning in what they do not fill.

CASE 26 // FILE B
THE CASE OF THE EMPTY ROOMS

DECODE the message hidden across the 14 selected maps.

• Use only the fourteen completed spatial cases listed on the next page. Case 01 is not part of this extraction set.

• In each final map, find the one named ROOM containing zero people.

• Record the first letter of each empty ROOM in case order.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 123.

CASE 26 // STORY BRIDGE

THE CASE OF THE EMPTY ROOMS

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 124

CASE WALL -> PAGE 13 MESSAGES / RULES Copy the fourteen-letter instruction you extracted from the empty-room initials exactly as you solved it. Do not check the Solution Files first unless you actually want the answer.

CASE 27 // FILE A

BIBI'S MAP HAS ONE ROOM WITH ZERO DOORS

Fourteen empty-room initials give you one instruction: CHECK THE OLD MAP. Bibi does not need asking twice. She pulls a retained Academy plan from the archive, takes one of the recovered overlay sleeves from the Guest House parcel and lays the modern building map over the old one. Three landmarks appear on both plans: the North Stair, the Courtyard Column and the West Lift Shaft. Much of the building has changed. Before you can trust either plan alone, you need to line them up.

BIBI:

Clean hands. Flat map. No heroic folding.

ALIO:

What about a small heroic point?

BIBI:

One finger. A landmark. I can allow it.

DILO:

We solved a parcel just to earn permission for one finger.

BIBI:

A worthy investment.

CASE 27 // FILE B

BIBI'S MAP HAS ONE ROOM WITH ZERO DOORS

ALIGN the plans and locate the sealed room.

• Keep both plans at the same scale and orientation. • Align the three fixed landmarks before looking for the room that exists only on the old plan.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 127.

CASE 28 // FILE A

RULE ZERO

The missing room lands directly behind the modern Archive wall. Alio takes one interested step toward it. Bibi raises one finger. He stops. On the old-plan margin is a second instruction:

RULE FIRST, ROOM SECOND.

Earlier, you saved RULE 0 FIRST from Bibi's photograph. The two fragments clearly belong together - but Rule Zero is still incomplete. Bibi taps the tracking-yard file from Case 24. "The arrow looked certain," she says. "The mud was right." This close to the end, one exciting assumption could send all this careful work in the wrong direction.

CASE 28 // COMMS

RULE ZERO

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

ALIO:

I have put my tunnel theory on a separate card.

LULI:

How much evidence is on the card?

ALIO:

At present? Decorative confidence.

MIMI:

Better than the muddy arrows. At least your theory admits it is guessing.

BIBI:

That would have saved my old squad several afternoons.

CASE 28 // FILE B
RULE ZERO

SORT the claims into FACT, THEORY and UNSUPPORTED ASSUMPTION, then choose the one word that correctly restores Rule Zero. After you solve it, copy the complete restored rule to MESSAGES / RULES on your Case Wall, page 13.

• FACT = directly observed or deduced from evidence. • THEORY = possible explanation linked to facts but not yet proved. • UNSUPPORTED ASSUMPTION = extra claim with no supporting evidence.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 131.

CASE 29 // FILE A

THE MAP BENEATH THE MAP

Rule Zero is complete:

ZERO ASSUMPTIONS. NOTICE FIRST. THEORIZE SECOND.

Alio looks at the sealed wall. The wall remains impressively sealed. Dilo waits. Nothing. "I was hoping for at least a click," he says. Rule Zero was never a password. It is an instruction. So instead of guessing at the panel, Mimi requests the old service-level access record for the exact section behind the Archive. What comes back is the largest position map in the book. The service level is crowded with old workstations, blocked routes and one placement the record treats as certain: Seth. The system panel needs a coordinate. The service map is the only surviving record precise enough to produce one. To get it, you first have to solve who shares Seth's area - because that second placement is tied to the access coordinate the panel is waiting for.

CASE 29 // COMMS

THE MAP BENEATH THE MAP

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS

MIMI:

Largest map in the book. Same rule as always: prove it.

NINI:

Take your time. We are not going anywhere.

DILO:

I can be quiet for one map.

LULI:

New evidence already.

BIBI:

Make the call when you're ready.

CASE 29 // FILE B
THE MAP BENEATH THE MAP

SOLVE the final map. Give the one person sharing Seth’s mapped area and the access coordinate.

• Use the Standard Map Case Rules on page 11. • PERSON MAY STAND ON: bleacher, desk, stool.
• SQUARE BLOCKED BY: globe, lab bench, lockers, piano, teacher's desk.

CASE 29 // WITNESS RECORD

01 Mavis was north-west of Vega.

02 Cato was north-east of Ren.

03 Jules was diagonally next to Wade.

04 Bryn shared a space with Jules.

05 Vega was north-west of Cato.

06 Ren was in the Control Room.

07 Poppy shared a room with Mavis.

08 Wade was in the Operations Office, beside the teacher's desk.

09 Seth's final area contained exactly one other person.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 135.

STORY BRIDGE

ACT 5 // THE DOOR OPENS

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 136

CASE WALL -> PAGE 13 CODES / COORDINATES Copy the access coordinate you earned from the final map. Do not write a new coordinate later - the finale uses this one. The old service map gives you the final location answer. Mimi closes the file and points at your Case Wall. "Bring what you already earned." Take page 13 and your Recruit Credential into the final case.

CASE 30 // STORY BRIDGE

THE MYSTERY OF ROOM ZERO

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 137

The access coordinate brings the squad back to the sealed panel behind the Archive.
It lights four empty fields:
RULE WORD / ACCESS / CODE / CALL SIGN
Then it waits.
No printer cough. No hidden drawer. No new clue.
Dilo looks at the panel, then at the Case Wall, then at you.
For the first time since the black envelope arrived, the Academy is asking for nothing new.
It is asking whether you kept what you
already proved.

HAPPY MAKERS COMMS
1
MIMI: Use what you earned.
2
DILO: Victory noise?
3
LULI: Pending evidence.
4
NINI: Very pending.
5
BIBI: Begin.

CASE 30 // STORY BRIDGE

THE MYSTERY OF ROOM ZERO

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 138

YOUR OBJECTIVE
COMPLETE the four final checks using answers already in your book.

WITNESS BOARD // CLUE EVIDENCE
Every final field comes from earlier work; do not invent a new answer.
RULE WORD is the missing word you restored in Rule Zero.
ACCESS is the final coordinate you saved from the service map.
CODE is the six-symbol sequence already on your Case Wall.
CALL SIGN is the Official Call Sign on your Recruit Credential.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 139.

STORY CONTINUES

ROOM ZERO // THE DOOR OPENS

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 140

The panel accepts the fourth answer. For one second, nothing happens. Dilo inhales for a victory noise. Luli raises one finger. "Evidence first." The old display built into the sealed panel flickers awake. The display shows a dated routing log beside images of the old Academy plan, a plain 0 stamp and intake templates. Then the screen places two pieces of handwriting side by side: the back of Bibi's photograph and the torn note from Case 21. Same slanted R. Same crossed T. A final archive line appears:

ROUTE NOTE AUTHOR: BIBI // TRAINEE ARCHIVE TEAM

Nobody speaks. Bibi leans closer. "Oh," she says. "That was me." A lock releases inside the wall. The sealed panel opens onto a small old training room. No hidden villain. No treasure. No machine that solved the cases for you. Just a room built around one old Academy rule.

BIBI: When I was your age, my squad started here with zero assumptions. We left route notes so unfinished training could be continued by the next session.

LULI: And the route stayed unfinished.

MIMI: Until the current roster showed five active field detectives and one empty sixth position.

The routing log scrolls.
ROUTE FUNCTION: MATCH / ROUTE / VERIFY
CASE CREATION: NONE
FIELD POSITION 06: UNASSIGNED

ALIO: So the system did not put the Cup back?

EVERYONE: No.

DILO: Good. That would have raised several technical questions.

BIBI: The cases were real. The old route could flag a current record that matched one of its unfinished training steps, then reopen archived material when a verified step unlocked it.

NINI: The 071 photograph.

BIBI: Exactly. And later, the old note and the plan. Real archive pieces, reopened at the moment the route needed them.

LULI: It could mark, match and route evidence.

MIMI: It could not create a case, choose a suspect or solve anything for us.

Nini looks at the four answers you just entered.

NINI: Which is why every field came from work you already did.

DILO: The code.

LULI: The rule word.

ALIO: D3.

MIMI: And your call sign.

The screen changes.
TRAINING ROUTE: COMPLETE
FIELD POSITION 06: READY FOR CERTIFICATION
Bibi looks at the Recruit Credential you chose to sign at the beginning.

BIBI: The system could send an invitation to whoever held the book.

NINI: It could not choose your name.

LULI: Or make your verdicts.

MIMI: Or keep going for you.

Dilo finally lowers his voice.

DILO: So the empty place was real.

BIBI: Yes.

MIMI: But nobody could fill it for you.

The Academy could open the door. Only you could earn the place.

THE SIXTH HOOK
Mimi sets the portable certification rack on the table.
The same rack you saw beside the Case Table when you claimed your Recruit Credential.
Five badges already hang in their places.
Hook 06 is still empty.
Nini looks at your Recruit Credential.
Luli looks at the completed maps.
Dilo looks at the final panel and very deliberately keeps both hands in his pockets.
Alio has brought the helmet. Nobody asks why.
Bibi turns the empty hook toward you.

STORY CONTINUES

ROOM ZERO // THE DOOR OPENS

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 144

“There was a place waiting,” she says. “But the Academy could not fill it for you.” Mimi smiles. “You did that part.”

DETECTIVE ACADEMY // FIELD CERTIFICATION
AWARDED TO:
OFFICIAL CALL SIGN:
FOR SOLVING THE MYSTERY OF ROOM ZERO
BY FOLLOWING THE EVIDENCE ALL THE WAY TO THE TRUTH.
CERTIFIED FIELD DETECTIVE // FIELD SLOT 06
ROOM ZERO // CASE CLOSED
Signed: Happy Makers Detective Academy
Archive confirmation: BIBI // ARCHIVE MENTOR

Use the same call sign from your Recruit Credential. This certificate records what you earned; it is not another recruit card.

Mimi clips the badge to the rack. Five occupied hooks become six.

MIMI: Welcome to the team.

LULI: They were already on the team.

MIMI: I know. Now the paperwork agrees.

DILO: I have never respected paperwork more.

BIBI: Enjoy the feeling. It will pass.

No fanfare is required. Dilo tries a tiny victory noise. Nini adds an even tinier one. Mimi is smiling too much to overrule either of them.

For one whole minute, the Academy manages to be quiet. Almost. The team puts down its pencils. Bibi closes the Book 1 routing log and slides it into the archive tray. Beside it is a small release flap. Bibi points at it. “That can wait.” Dilo waits. Technically. Then he lifts the flap. A dormant slot clicks. A new file slides onto the tray. This one does not carry the plain 0. On the cover is a triangular archive symbol. Luli freezes. "Wait." She flips back to the Look-Twice file from Case 03. The 017 / 071 mismatch sent them to older archive files. The symbol on this new cover gives them another question to record.

NINI: One changed number sent us to the archive.

LULI: And the archive still has more to tell us.

DILO: Case Three has returned from the dead.

MIMI: Case Three is solved. This is a new question.

BIBI: Which means we keep the archive trail open.

Inside is an old team photograph.
One person has been cut out.
On the back, in faded type:
RETURN BEFORE THE FIRST MEETING.

BIBI: I recognize that file. I do not know why it has come back.

DILO: That was less than one quiet minute.

LULI: An impressively accurate measurement.

ALIO: I have not even reassigned the helmet yet.

MIMI: Detective, are you still with us?

NEXT FILE INCOMING.

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THE ENVELOPE THAT WAS NEVER DELIVERED

FILE 16 / BOARD 17 / PUZZLE 18

HINTS 152/161/170 / SOLUTION 179

THE TROPHY THAT CAME BACK TOO EARLY

FILE 19 / BOARD 20 / PUZZLE 21

HINTS 152/161/170 / SOLUTION 181

LULI'S LOOK-TWICE FILE

FILE 22/23 / BOARD 24 / PUZZLE 25

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THE EVIDENCE BOX IN THE WRONG TENT

FILE 27 / BOARD 28 / PUZZLE 29

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DILO'S CODE THAT DEFINITELY WASN'T 123456

FILE 30/31 / BOARD 32 / PUZZLE 33

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THE DRAGON TOOTH THAT WAS ACTUALLY A SPOON

FILE 36/37 / BOARD 38 / PUZZLE 39

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ALIO'S ABSOLUTELY SAFE SHORTCUT

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THE SYMBOL THAT SHOULDN'T BE HERE

FILE 48/49 / BOARD 50 / PUZZLE 51

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THE PARROT WHO KNEW THE PASSWORD

FILE 60/61 / BOARD 62 / PUZZLE 63

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THE CAMERA THAT BLINKED AT 4:17

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ONE WITNESS IS ACCIDENTALLY IMPOSSIBLE

FILE 68/69 / BOARD 70 / PUZZLE 71

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THE BACKPACK THAT CHANGED OWNERS

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GRANDMA BIBI'S VERY OLD, VERY EMBARRASSING PHOTOGRAPH

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THE TRAIN TICKET THAT WASN'T LOST

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OUT

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BIBI'S MAP HAS ONE ROOM WITH ZERO DOORS

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THE THREE-LEVEL VAULT

HINT VAULT

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 150

LEVEL 1 / LEVEL 2 / LEVEL 3

LEVEL 1

LEVEL 2

LEVEL 3

READ ONLY YOUR CASE

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 1

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 151

WHERE TO LOOK FIRST

Read only the hint for your case. Then go back. The goal is to restart your thinking, not finish it for you. Using a hint still counts as solving — detectives use tools.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 1

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 1

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 152

CASE 01 / HINT LEVEL 1

Start with the two row clues and the two column clues. Do not combine them too early.

CASE 02 / HINT LEVEL 1

Start with Nova. Row 3 plus column B fixes B3 immediately.

CASE 03 / HINT LEVEL 1

Sweep the room in zones: table, piano, sofa, shelves, globe, rug and foreground. There are exactly ten deliberate changes.

CASE 04 / HINT LEVEL 1

Start with Echo. Row 2 plus column A fixes A2.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 1

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 1

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 153

CASE 05 / HINT LEVEL 1

Treat STAR -> BOLT as one two-symbol block. Then compare which symbols must sit before and after that block.

CASE 06 / HINT LEVEL 1

Start with Scout. Row 3 plus column E gives an exact square.

CASE 07 / HINT LEVEL 1

Rocket has the cleanest exact clue. Place E5 first.

CASE 08 / HINT LEVEL 1

Do not compare distance first. Cross out any route that breaks a hard rule.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 1

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 1

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 154

CASE 09 / HINT LEVEL 1

Compare shape and context, not just anything circular.

CASE 10 / HINT LEVEL 1

Wyatt has the tightest starting clue: column B plus the charging pod.

CASE 11 / HINT LEVEL 1

Use the hard time window before judging what an object looks like.

CASE 12 / HINT LEVEL 1

Cove's column plus outer-wall clue is the cleanest place to start.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 1

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 1

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 155

CASE 13 / HINT LEVEL 1

Moxie's Ranger Station plus row-5 clue is the best anchor.

CASE 14 / HINT LEVEL 1

Treat the statements as timing claims, not honesty tests.

CASE 15 / HINT LEVEL 1

Duke's First Aid Hut plus row-5 clue is the best anchor.

CASE 16 / HINT LEVEL 1

Everything you need is printed on the evidence page. Do not use real-world technology history.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 1

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 1

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 156

CASE 17 / HINT LEVEL 1

Koa's Waiting Lounge plus row-6 clue is the best anchor.

CASE 18 / HINT LEVEL 1

Convert every time to real time before ordering any events.

CASE 19 / HINT LEVEL 1

Kian's Study Hall plus column-F clue is the cleanest anchor.

CASE 20 / HINT LEVEL 1

Mara's Main Studio plus row-4 clue is the best starting anchor.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 1

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 1

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 157

CASE 21 / HINT LEVEL 1

Start with the only scrap that has a straight left edge.

CASE 22 / HINT LEVEL 1

Wes's locker clue is the best opening constraint.

CASE 23 / HINT LEVEL 1

Vivi's exact distance is a strong starting constraint.

CASE 24 / HINT LEVEL 1

Ignore the decorative arrow in the tread. Track what changes from print to print.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 1

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 1

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 158

CASE 25 / HINT LEVEL 1

Casey's Lobby plus column-D clue is the tightest anchor.

CASE 26 / HINT LEVEL 1

The 0 is not a room number. Read it as a quantity. MAP LOOKUP // Cases 02, 04, 06, 07, 10, 12, 13, 15, 17, 19, 20, 22, 23 and 25. Use the case numbers in this list to find the selected maps.

CASE 27 / HINT LEVEL 1

Do not align the paper edges. Align permanent landmarks.

CASE 28 / HINT LEVEL 1

Sort every claim before touching the word bank. The correct Rule Zero word must describe what unsupported claims have in common.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 1

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 1

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 159

CASE 29 / HINT LEVEL 1

Wade's Operations Office plus teacher-desk clue is the best anchor.

CASE 30 / HINT LEVEL 1

All four inputs are already in your book: RULE WORD, ACCESS, CODE and CALL SIGN.

Retrieve; do not invent.

READ ONLY YOUR CASE

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 2

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 160

NARROW THE SEARCH

Still stuck? This level removes more wrong paths, but the final step should still be yours. If Level 1 was not enough,

that is exactly what Level 2 is for.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 2

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 2

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 161

CASE 01 / HINT LEVEL 2

MORSE and KNOX already use columns C and D. That leaves A and B for PIP and QUILL. Clue 5 puts PIP to the left, so PIP is A3 and QUILL is B1.

CASE 02 / HINT LEVEL 2

Then place Dax and Rook. Their room/column and corner/desk clues consume key rows and columns.

CASE 03 / HINT LEVEL 2

Check the foreground case label, centre sofa cushion, shield rim, ring-shaped award, phone stand base, recorder front, pen, right glass-case crystal, piano pedals and shelf camera.

CASE 04 / HINT LEVEL 2

Zuri's Pickup Tent plus row-4 clue and Clover's Packing Room plus row-5 clue are strong anchors.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 2

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 2

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 162

CASE 05 / HINT LEVEL 2

BALL is before STAR. HEART is after BOLT but cannot be fifth. KEY is before MOON, and HEART is also before MOON.

CASE 06 / HINT LEVEL 2

Then place Arlo and Vale. Their room clues sharply reduce the free rows and columns.

CASE 07 / HINT LEVEL 2

Next compare the remaining options for Willa and Blaze before deciding Indigo's either/or clue.

CASE 08 / HINT LEVEL 2

Route A touches the closed paint corridor. Route B needs a locked door.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 2

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 2

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 163

CASE 09 / HINT LEVEL 2

The true marks are plain, deliberate and attached to case evidence.

CASE 10 / HINT LEVEL 2

Use Beck's outer-wall/crate clue, then test the remaining demo-seat choices.

CASE 11 / HINT LEVEL 2

The science-fair case begins at 15:20. One item's only timestamp is 08:07.

CASE 12 / HINT LEVEL 2

Use Kira's solo Bird Room clue to settle the either/or and exactly-one statements.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 2

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 2

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 164

CASE 13 / HINT LEVEL 2

Once Moxie and Skye are placed, use Juno's diagonal link and Eden's same-room link.

CASE 14 / HINT LEVEL 2

Each map edge takes 2 minutes. Count the edges between the two places in each claim.

CASE 15 / HINT LEVEL 2

Then use the two north-east relationships and the cot clues.

CASE 16 / HINT LEVEL 2

The crest identifies the building. Then intersect the badge range with the security-upgrade date.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 2

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 2

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 165

CASE 17 / HINT LEVEL 2

Then place Luna and Mika before resolving Otis's either/or.

CASE 18 / HINT LEVEL 2

Add 7 minutes to Cafe Clock records. Subtract 2 minutes from Dilo's watch.

CASE 19 / HINT LEVEL 2

Use Theo and Dex's shared-room relationship, then the Ollie/Avery exactly-one clue.

CASE 20 / HINT LEVEL 2

Use Asa's same-room clue and Luca's diagonal relationship before the north/south chain.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 2

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 2

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 166

CASE 21 / HINT LEVEL 2

Match the notch pair before reading the sentence.

CASE 22 / HINT LEVEL 2

Use Cody's diagonal link, then Gia's exact distance.

CASE 23 / HINT LEVEL 2

Then use Pia's exactly-one Snack Stand clue and Mae's bench clue.

CASE 24 / HINT LEVEL 2

Mud is strongest at the first print and fades with each step.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 2

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 2

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 167

CASE 25 / HINT LEVEL 2

Place Wynn, then use Tate's diagonal relationship.

CASE 26 / HINT LEVEL 2

Count people only in spaces marked ROOM. Ignore ZONES.

CASE 27 / HINT LEVEL 2

Match the stair, courtyard column and lift shaft.

CASE 28 / HINT LEVEL 2

A theory can fit the facts but is not yet proven. An assumption adds something the evidence never said.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 2

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 2

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 168

CASE 29 / HINT LEVEL 2

Resolve Jules/Bryn and the Ren/Cato/Vega direction chain.

CASE 30 / HINT LEVEL 2

Case 28 supplies the word; Case 29 the coordinate; Case 05 the symbol sequence.

READ ONLY YOUR CASE

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 3

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 169

STRONGEST NUDGE

Use this when you want the puzzle nearly opened for you. Stop before the final answer if you can; if you cannot, read

the Solution File and learn the route.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 3

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 3

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 170

CASE 01 / HINT LEVEL 3

Rows 2 and 4 are still open for MORSE and KNOX. Clue 6 puts MORSE lower, so MORSE is C4 and KNOX is D2 in Delivery.

CASE 02 / HINT LEVEL 3

Max is forced to E1. Check who is the only other person sharing his final room.

CASE 03 / HINT LEVEL 3

There are exactly TEN differences. Check the phone stand base, the piano pedals (2 in Photo A; 3 in Photo B) and the shelf camera. Count each location once.

CASE 04 / HINT LEVEL 3

Pixel is forced to E1 in the Pickup Tent. Which single person shares that final room?

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 3

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 3

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 171

CASE 05 / HINT LEVEL 3

Test where the STAR-BOLT block can sit. Only one placement leaves BALL before it and still lets HEART, KEY and MOON satisfy all three later-order clues.

CASE 06 / HINT LEVEL 3

Once Hugo is forced into the Dinosaur Gallery, check who is the only person sharing Uma's final space.

CASE 07 / HINT LEVEL 3

When the rows and columns collapse, Zoe is C6. Check who shares Gray's final space.

CASE 08 / HINT LEVEL 3

Only Route C reaches the Prop Room without crossing a blocked edge.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 3

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 3

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 172

CASE 09 / HINT LEVEL 3

Three later Academy records plus the black-envelope intake record use the same plain 0. Treat four matching records as a pattern, not an explanation.

CASE 10 / HINT LEVEL 3

When Dash settles at E3, check who is the only other person in the Assembly Hall.

CASE 11 / HINT LEVEL 3

Record D is the 08:07 phone photo. It falls outside the case window; that is enough to classify it.

CASE 12 / HINT LEVEL 3

Winter ends in the Stage Wing. Check the only other person there.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 3

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 3

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 173

CASE 13 / HINT LEVEL 3

Finish the north-west/south-west chain. Remy's room then has only one companion.

CASE 14 / HINT LEVEL 3

Stage to Dressing needs two edges, or 4 minutes. Noah gives himself only 2.

CASE 15 / HINT LEVEL 3

Milo ends in the Games Cabin. Which single person shares it?

CASE 16 / HINT LEVEL 3

1998 is before the 2001 sticker; 2008 is after the badge and photo-envelope ranges. Only 2002 fits.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 3

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 3

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 174

CASE 17 / HINT LEVEL 3

Axel must be exactly three rows north of Koa. Check who shares Reed's final area.

CASE 18 / HINT LEVEL 3

The real times become 15:15, 15:16, 15:17 and 15:18.

CASE 19 / HINT LEVEL 3

Mack must be south-west of Ollie. Check who ends with Sasha.

CASE 20 / HINT LEVEL 3

Demi ends in the Safety Station. Which person shares it?

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 3

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 3

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 175

CASE 21 / HINT LEVEL 3

The physical edge order is B-D-A-C.

CASE 22 / HINT LEVEL 3

Zara ends in the Rehearsal Room. Which person shares it?

CASE 23 / HINT LEVEL 3

Place Cora before Rae. Two columns east becomes decisive late in the solve.

CASE 24 / HINT LEVEL 3

The darkest print is at the East Path and the faintest at the West Gate.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 3

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 3

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 176

CASE 25 / HINT LEVEL 3

Nori ends in the Lobby. Check the only person sharing it.

CASE 26 / HINT LEVEL 3

The fourteen empty-room initials read C-H-E-C-K / T-H-E / O-L-D / M-A-P.

CASE 27 / HINT LEVEL 3

After the three anchors overlap, one old rectangular room has no current doorway.

CASE 28 / HINT LEVEL 3

After the six-card sort is correct, compare the four word-bank choices. Only ASSUMPTIONS matches the method you just used.

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 3

HINT VAULT // LEVEL 3

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 177

CASE 29 / HINT LEVEL 3

Seth ends in the Equipment Hall. The only other person there gives the access coordinate.

CASE 30 / HINT LEVEL 3

RULE WORD comes from Rule Zero. ACCESS comes from Case 29. CODE comes from Case 05. CALL SIGN comes from your Recruit Credential.

CHECK YOUR REASONING

SOLUTION FILES

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 178

CHECK THE REASON, NOT JUST THE ANSWER.

A correct answer matters. Knowing why it is correct matters more.

Your route through a puzzle may look different from the steps below; what matters is that every clue still fits and the final answer

is forced by the evidence. If you used a hint, check the reasoning anyway — that is how one difficult case makes the next one easier.

CASE 01 // SOLUTION

THE ENVELOPE THAT WAS NEVER DELIVERED

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 179

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: KNOX at D2

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 QUILL is in row 1 and PIP is in row 3. 02 MORSE is in column C and KNOX is in column D.

03 Every helper must use a different row and a different column. 04 Columns C and D are already taken by MORSE and KNOX, so QUILL and PIP must use A and B.

05 PIP is left of QUILL, which makes PIP A3 and QUILL B1. 06 Rows 1 and 3 are now used. MORSE and KNOX must use rows 2 and 4.

07 MORSE is in a lower row than KNOX, so MORSE is C4 and KNOX is D2. 08 D2 is inside Delivery.

WHY IT MATTERS

The first file teaches the Academy method properly: combine different clue types, then use elimination to finish the grid.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 180.

CASE 02 // SOLUTION

THE TROPHY THAT CAME BACK TOO EARLY

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 181

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: Dax at D2

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 Nova is fixed at B3. 02 Dax is D2 in the Display Room.

03 Rook resolves to A6 and Atlas to F4. 04 Max is forced to E1; Ivy takes C5.

05 Dax is the only other person sharing Max's final room, so Dax is the answer.

WHY IT MATTERS

The team now has a specific witness to interview about the unexplained return, without treating proximity as guilt.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 182.

CASE 03 // SOLUTION

LULI'S LOOK-TWICE FILE

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 183

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: ALL 10 DIFFERENCES

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

FOREGROUND CASE LABEL — Photo A: 017;

Photo B: 071.

CENTRE SOFA CUSHION — Photo A: pale

pattern; Photo B: small checks.

SHIELD RIM — Photo A: narrow dark rim; Photo

B: wide bright dotted rim.

RING-SHAPED AWARD — Photo A: tall narrow

oval; Photo B: wider rounder ring.

PHONE STAND BASE — Photo A: rectangular

base; Photo B: circular base.

RECORDER FRONT — Photo A: plain front;

Photo B: visible buttons.

PEN — Photo A: horizontal; Photo B: diagonal.

RIGHT GLASS-CASE CRYSTAL — Photo A: tall narrow crystal; Photo B: wide diamond-shaped crystal.

PIANO PEDALS — Photo A: 2 pedals; Photo B: 3

pedals.

SHELF CAMERA — Photo A: black raised top;

Photo B: silver-topped.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 184.

CASE 04 // SOLUTION

THE EVIDENCE BOX IN THE WRONG TENT

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 185

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: Zuri at F4

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 Echo is fixed at A2. 02 Zuri is F4 in the Pickup Tent.

03 Briar resolves to D3 beside the ring-toss

stand. 04 Clover is C5; Kai is B6.

05 Pixel is E1 in the Pickup Tent. 06 Zuri is the only other person sharing Pixel's final room, so Zuri is the answer.

WHY IT MATTERS

The team now knows which person can clarify the evidence-box handoff at Open Night.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 186.

CASE 05 // SOLUTION

DILO'S CODE THAT DEFINITELY WASN'T 123456

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 187

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: BALL -> STAR -> BOLT -> HEART -> KEY -> MOON

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 STAR must sit immediately before BOLT. 02 BALL must be somewhere before STAR.

03 HEART must come after BOLT and

cannot be fifth. 04 KEY must come before MOON.

05 HEART must also come before MOON. 06 Testing the possible positions leaves one

sequence: BALL -> STAR -> BOLT ->

HEART -> KEY -> MOON.

WHY IT MATTERS

The code opens the dormant locker and reveals an old routing card stamped 0 and marked INCOMPLETE. The code itself is saved for the final lock.

CASE 06 // SOLUTION

THE DRAGON TOOTH THAT WAS ACTUALLY A SPOON

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 188

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: Arlo at D2

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 Scout is fixed at E3. 02 Arlo must be D2 in the Foyer.

03 Vale resolves to F5 in the Gallery. 04 Wren is C4 and Hugo is A6 in the

Dinosaur Gallery.

05 Uma is B1 in the Foyer. 06 Arlo is the only other person with Uma,

so Arlo is the answer.

WHY IT MATTERS

The team now has the witness who can tell Uma whether the display object or the label changed during

the missing window; the map still proves contact, not blame.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 189.

CASE 07 // SOLUTION

THE COSTUME THAT WALKED AWAY

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 190

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: Zoe at C6

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 Rocket is fixed at E5. 02 Willa resolves to B1.

03 Blaze resolves to A3 in the Rehearsal

Room. 04 Indigo is forced to D2 in the Dressing

Room.

05 Zoe is C6 beside the costume cart; Gray

is F4. 06 Zoe is the only other person in Gray's

final space.

WHY IT MATTERS

The trainer now has a real person to question about when the moon costume left its rack.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 191.

CASE 08 // SOLUTION

ALIO'S ABSOLUTELY SAFE SHORTCUT

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 192

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: C

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 Route A fails because the Paint Corridor

is closed. 02 Route B fails because the Staff Stairs are

locked.

03 Route C uses Costume Storage and the

Side Hall, both open. 04 Route C is the only valid shortcut.

WHY IT MATTERS

The squad reaches the prop room without entering the closed Paint Corridor or using the locked Staff

Stairs.

CASE 09 // SOLUTION

THE SYMBOL THAT SHOULDN'T BE HERE

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 193

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: THE PLAIN 0 IS A RECURRING ACADEMY MARK.

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 Remove the poster circle and stage dial;

their shapes and functions differ. 02 The remaining marks use the same plain

0 form.

03 They occur on unrelated evidence across

multiple cases. 04 The pattern is real, but its meaning

remains unknown.

WHY IT MATTERS

Bibi's reaction now deserves an archive check, but the mark still proves no theory by itself.

CASE 10 // SOLUTION

THE ROBOT WITH TWO OWNERS

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 194

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: Ember at D5

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 Wyatt is fixed at B7 in the Robotics Lab. 02 Ember resolves to D5; Beck to C1.

03 Nico is F6, Vera G4 and Finn A2. 04 Dash is E3 in the Assembly Hall.

05 Ember is the only other person in the Assembly Hall, so Ember is the answer.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Tech Lab now has a contact who can clarify the split access records before anyone claims the rover.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 195.

CASE 11 // SOLUTION

MIMI'S EVIDENCE BAG PROBLEM

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 196

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: D

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 The science-fair evidence window begins

at 15:20. 02 Items A-C are labeled inside that window.

03 Pens and snack are ordinary bag contents but not contradictory evidence. 04 The phone photo record is from 08:07, so

it was created outside the science-fair

event window.

05 Record D is the only timestamped record

outside 15:20-16:05.

WHY IT MATTERS

Removing Record D keeps an unrelated timestamp from distorting the Science & Prototype Fair timeline.

CASE 12 // SOLUTION

THE PARROT WHO KNEW THE PASSWORD

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 197

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: Nell at G2

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 Cove is B7. 02 Nell resolves to G2 in the Stage Wing; Iris to A5.

03 Kira is E6 in the Bird Room and Eli is F4 in the Green Room. 04 Sage resolves to C3 in the Rehearsal Room.

05 Winter is D1 in the Stage Wing. 06 Nell is the only other person with Winter, so Nell is the answer.

WHY IT MATTERS

Nell can trace the four-word phrase to an ordinary rehearsal cue, showing that the parrot repeated familiar words rather than exposing a password.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 198.

CASE 13 // SOLUTION

THE CAMERA THAT BLINKED AT 4:17

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 199

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: Bodhi at B7

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 Moxie resolves to C5 and Skye to E4 in the Ranger Station. 02 Juno is F3 and Eden G2. 03 Bodhi resolves to B7 after applying the directional chain. 04 Willow is A1 and Remy is D6. 05 Bodhi is the only other person in Remy's Research Lab, so Bodhi is the answer.

WHY IT MATTERS

The maintenance trail now has a witness who can help establish when the camera moved.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 200.

CASE 14 // SOLUTION

ONE WITNESS IS ACCIDENTALLY IMPOSSIBLE

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 201

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: NOAH

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 Dressing and Stage are not directly connected; Hall sits between them. 02 Each edge takes 2 minutes.

03 Stage -> Hall -> Dressing therefore takes

4 minutes. 04 NOAH claims the same move happened

between 16:10 and 16:12.

05 His memory is the impossible one. It can

be mistaken without being dishonest.

WHY IT MATTERS

The team has proved a timing error, not a lie - an important distinction for later cases.

CASE 15 // SOLUTION

THE BACKPACK THAT CHANGED OWNERS

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 202

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: Harper at D2

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 Duke resolves to E5 in the First Aid Hut. 02 Piper is F4 and Cruz C3.

03 Jett is G7 in the Welcome Lodge. 04 Harper resolves to D2; Inez to B6.

05 Milo is A1 in the Games Cabin. 06 Harper is the only other person in Milo's

Games Cabin, so Harper is the answer.

WHY IT MATTERS

The backpack handoff can now be traced without turning an ordinary mix-up into an accusation.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 203.

CASE 16 // SOLUTION

GRANDMA BIBI'S VERY OLD, VERY EMBARRASSING

PHOTOGRAPH

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 204

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: building: OLD ACADEMY ANNEX; year: 2002

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 The visible crest and TRAINING ANNEX plaque identify the Old Academy Annex. 02 The striped badge can only be from

1999-2003.

03 The security sticker requires 2001 or

later. 04 The processing log says the envelope

was used before its 2004 expiry.

05 Of the three offered years, only 2002

satisfies every clue. 06 The back of the photograph adds the unexplained message: RULE 0 FIRST.

WHY IT MATTERS

The verified date and building make the message on the back of Bibi's photograph usable evidence.

CASE 17 // SOLUTION

THE TRAIN TICKET THAT WASN'T LOST

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 205

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: Axel at E3

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 Koa resolves to F6 and Luna to G7 in the

Waiting Lounge. 02 Mika is B4 in the Ticket Office; Sunny

resolves to D5.

03 Otis is A1. 04 Axel is E3, exactly three rows north of

Koa.

05 Reed is C2 in the Main Corridor. 06 Axel is the only other person in Reed's

final area.

WHY IT MATTERS

The station inquiry now has a contact, while the conflicting clocks remain a separate problem to solve.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 206.

CASE 18 // SOLUTION

THE SEVEN-MINUTE ALIBI

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 207

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: A □ B □ C □ D

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 Cafe 15:08 becomes real 15:15. 02 Dilo 15:18 becomes real 15:16.

03 Station 15:17 is already real 15:17. 04 Cafe 15:11 becomes real 15:18.

05 The only order is A, B, C, D.

WHY IT MATTERS

The suspicious 0:07 collapses into ordinary clock arithmetic, giving the team a clean false lead to discard.

CASE 19 // SOLUTION

THE LIBRARY BOOK THAT CHECKED ITSELF OUT

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 208

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: Mack at A7

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 Kian resolves to F4. 02 Theo is C1 and Dex G2 in the Reference

Room.

03 Avery resolves to E5 and Ollie to D3. 04 Mack is A7, south-west of Ollie.

05 Sasha is B6 in the Returns Hall. 06 Mack is the only other person in Sasha's

final area.

WHY IT MATTERS

The librarian now has a concrete person to ask whether the scanner was used, bumped or misread.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 209.

CASE 20 // SOLUTION

THE PAINT-SPLATTERED ALIBI

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 210

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: Pax at F5

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 Mara resolves to D4 and Asa to B2 in the

Main Studio. 02 Luca becomes A1.

03 Toby resolves to C6 in the Workshop

Hall. 04 Pax is F5 and Sid E7.

05 Demi is G3 in the Safety Station. 06 Pax is the only other person in Demi's

final room.

WHY IT MATTERS

Pax can explain why the two paint accounts seemed to clash, and the complete placement map you

preserved becomes evidence again later.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 211.

CASE 21 // SOLUTION

THE NOTE IN FOUR PIECES

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 212

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: B □ D □ A □ C; THE ANSWER IS IN WHAT YOU LEAVE EMPTY.

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 B must begin because it has the straight

left edge. 02 B's right notch joins D.

03 D joins A, then A joins C. 04 The completed note reads: THE ANSWER

IS IN WHAT YOU LEAVE EMPTY.

WHY IT MATTERS

For the first time, the larger mystery gives the team an instruction instead of another pattern to notice.

CASE 22 // SOLUTION

THE MUSIC ROOM MIX-UP

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 213

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: Cody at C4

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 Wes resolves to D3 in the Instrument

Locker Room. 02 Cody resolves diagonally to C4 in the

Rehearsal Room.

03 Gia is B1; Lex E6; Imani F7. 04 Nia is G5 in the Practice Hall.

05 Zara is A2 in the Rehearsal Room. 06 Cody is the only other person in Zara's

final room.

WHY IT MATTERS

The local mix-up can move forward, and the completed map becomes part of the evidence set needed

later.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 214.

CASE 23 // SOLUTION

THE WRISTBAND SWITCH AT ADVENTURE PARK

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 215

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: Rae at F6

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 Vivi resolves to G7 and Pia to B2. 02 Mae resolves to C5 and Cora to D1.

03 Ozzy becomes A3. 04 Jude is E4 in the Prize Tent.

05 Rae is F6, exactly two columns east of

Cora. 06 Rae is the only other person in Jude's

final room.

WHY IT MATTERS

The wristband inquiry has a next contact, and another complete map joins the growing set.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 216.

CASE 24 // SOLUTION

THE FOOTPRINTS THAT WALKED BACKWARDS

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 217

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: EAST PATH -> WEST GATE

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 The first print after wet mud must carry the most mud. 02 Mud decreases 100 -> 70 -> 35 -> 10. 03 That sequence runs from the East Path toward the West Gate. 04 The tread arrow is a pattern on the sole, not proof of walking direction.

WHY IT MATTERS

The changing mud defeats the misleading arrow: observation wins over the most obvious-looking symbol.

CASE 25 // SOLUTION

THE PACKAGE WITH NO NAME

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 218

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: Casey at D5

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 Casey resolves to D5 in the Lobby. 02 Wynn is B7 and Tate C6 in the Laundry.

03 Gabe resolves to F3 and Rio E2. 04 Sol becomes G1.

05 Nori is A4 in the Lobby. 06 Casey is the only other person in Nori's

final room.

WHY IT MATTERS

Casey restores the missing parcel handoff, the Archive Restoration tools can be used, and the final required spatial map is complete.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 219.

CASE 26 // SOLUTION

THE CASE OF THE EMPTY ROOMS

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 220

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: CHECK THE OLD MAP

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 Each marked spatial case has exactly

one empty final ROOM. 02 Record the first letter of that room in

case order.

03 The fourteen letters are C H E C K T H E

O L D M A P.
04
The hidden instruction is CHECK THE

OLD MAP.

WHY IT MATTERS

The accumulated map work finally turns into a direction for the larger mystery.

CASE 27 // SOLUTION

BIBI'S MAP HAS ONE ROOM WITH ZERO DOORS

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 221

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: SEALED TRAINING ROOM BEHIND THE CURRENT ARCHIVE WALL

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 The North Stair fixes rotation. 02 The Courtyard Column fixes horizontal

position.

03 The West Lift Shaft confirms scale. 04 The old sealed training room lands directly behind the current Archive wall.

05 The note says RULE FIRST, ROOM

SECOND.

WHY IT MATTERS

The team now has a real place to investigate instead of a theory about a missing room.

CASE 28 // SOLUTION

RULE ZERO

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 222

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: ZERO ASSUMPTIONS. NOTICE FIRST. THEORIZE SECOND.

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 Sort direct observations into FACT. 02 Keep the unfinished-training-system idea

as a THEORY.

03 Move the secret watcher and guaranteed

tunnel into UNSUPPORTED

ASSUMPTION.

04
The restored rule is ZERO
ASSUMPTIONS. NOTICE FIRST.

THEORIZE SECOND.

WHY IT MATTERS

Rule Zero is restored, giving the team the method it needs before opening the sealed route.

CASE 29 // SOLUTION

THE MAP BENEATH THE MAP

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 223

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: Vega at D3

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 Wade resolves to F7. 02 Jules is E8 and Bryn G9.

03 Ren is H5 and Cato I4. 04 Vega resolves to D3; Mavis A2 and Poppy

C6.

05 Seth is B1 in the Equipment Hall. 06 Vega is the only other person in Seth's

final area.

07 The final access coordinate is D3.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Room Zero panel can now be tested with an earned coordinate rather than a guessed one.

Use the original puzzle or evidence artwork on page 224.

CASE 30 // SOLUTION

THE MYSTERY OF ROOM ZERO

HAPPY MAKERS / DETECTIVE ACADEMY 225

SOLUTION FILE // VERIFIED RESULT

ANSWER: RULE WORD = ASSUMPTIONS / ACCESS = D3 / CODE = BALL–STAR–BOLT–HEART–KEY–MOON / CALL SIGN = reader's official call sign

HOW THE EVIDENCE FITS

01 RULE WORD is ASSUMPTIONS, the missing word restored in Rule Zero. 02 ACCESS is D3, earned from Case 29.

03 CODE is BALL, STAR, BOLT, HEART, KEY,

MOON, earned in Case 05. 04 CALL SIGN is the Official Call Sign already written on the Recruit Credential.

05 All four entries come from evidence the

reader personally earned earlier in the

book.

06 The routing log can now certify Field

Position 06.

WHY IT MATTERS

The final lock does not reward a lucky guess. It rewards keeping, checking and reconnecting evidence

across the whole investigation.